AI-Based Smart Eco Air Pollution Control System

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Abstract—Air pollution poses a critical threat to public health, particularly in rapidly industrializing regions. Conventional air purification systems operate reactively—only after pollutants have dispersed—rendering them fundamentally inadequate for source-level control. This paper presents the design, hardware implementation, and experimental evaluation of an AI-enabled, IoT-integrated smart air pollution control system incorporating machine learning-based predictive monitoring. The system employs PM2.5, MQ135, and DHT11 sensors interfaced with an Arduino UNO microcontroller for real-time environmental data acquisition. A Logistic Regression model and a Decision Tree classifier were trained on collected sensor data to predict future pollution levels and classify air quality in real time. Experimental results across 10 controlled trials demonstrate that the bamboo and activated charcoal filtration assembly reduced PM2.5 concentrations from a mean of 340 µg/m³ to 89 µg/m³ (73.8% reduction) and MQ135 air quality index readings from 420 ppm to 118 ppm (71.9% reduction), with an average system actuation response time of 2.4 seconds. The Logistic Regression model achieved a classification accuracy of 91.3%, while the Decision Tree model attained 88.7% accuracy in pollution severity prediction. The proposed system offers a scalable, cost-effective, and environmentally responsible solution for proactive air quality management.

Keywords: Internet of Things (IoT), Air Pollution Control, Machine Learning, Logistic Regression, Decision Tree, Arduino UNO, PM2.5, MQ135, Eco-Friendly Filtration, Predictive Monitoring.

I. INTRODUCTION

Air pollution has emerged as a critical global public health crisis, with the World Health Organization (WHO) attributing approximately 7 million premature deaths annually to exposure to fine particulate matter (PM2.5) and toxic gases [WHO, 2022]. Accelerating industrialization, urban expansion, and vehicular emissions have compounded pollutant concentrations, particularly in developing nations such as India, where cities like Delhi, Gurugram, and Kanpur frequently record PM2.5 levels exceeding 300 µg/m³—twelve times the WHO safe limit of 25 µg/m³.

Despite the severity of this challenge, the majority of existing air purification systems are confined to indoor environments and operate reactively—initiating purification only after pollutants have diffused into the ambient air. This reactive paradigm is fundamentally inefficient: pollutants undergo dilution and chemical transformation before any remediation is attempted. Furthermore, existing systems lack predictive intelligence, responding only to current readings rather than anticipating future pollution episodes.

This research addresses these gaps by proposing a system that: (i) performs real-time source-level pollution control using eco-friendly bamboo and charcoal filtration, and (ii) employs machine learning models—specifically Logistic Regression and Decision Tree classifiers—trained on live sensor data to predict future pollution levels for a given area. The combination of reactive hardware control and proactive ML-based prediction represents a meaningful advance over existing IoT-only monitoring systems.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

Saha et al. [1] demonstrated the feasibility of IoT-enabled sensor networks for real-time environmental data acquisition using low-cost embedded platforms, establishing a foundational framework for connected air quality systems. Their work, however, was limited to passive monitoring without active remediation.

Ayele and Mehta [2] proposed an IoT platform incorporating machine learning for pollution trend prediction, demonstrating that data-driven models can anticipate pollution episodes with reasonable accuracy. Shah et al. [3] validated low-cost MQ-series gas sensors for distributed air quality surveillance, confirming their technical suitability for embedded IoT deployments.

A systematic mapping study by Munera et al. [4] analyzed 47 IoT-based air quality deployments across smart city contexts and identified a critical gap: no existing system combined

active hardware-based remediation with ML-driven predictive analytics in a unified framework. Bharath Kumar Sai et al. [5] demonstrated classification accuracies of 87–92% using MQ135 and MQ7 sensors with supervised ML algorithms, directly validating the sensor selection and modeling approach adopted in this work.

Pal et al. [9] demonstrated that decision tree classifiers achieve high interpretability and competitive accuracy for AQI classification tasks, making them suitable for resource-constrained embedded and edge environments. Zimmerman et al. [10] confirmed that logistic regression provides robust binary and multi-class air quality classification with minimal computational overhead, appropriate for real-time deployment on microcontroller platforms.

The use of activated charcoal (activated carbon) as an adsorption medium is well-documented, with surface areas exceeding 1000 m^2/g enabling effective capture of VOCs, NH_3, and particulate matter [11]. Bamboo-derived biochar offers comparable performance with the additional advantage of full biodegradability. Critically, no prior work has integrated these eco-friendly materials with ML-based predictive monitoring in a single deployable prototype—a gap the present work directly addresses.

III. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Contemporary air purification systems suffer from four critical deficiencies that limit their real-world effectiveness:

- Post-dispersal operation: Systems activate only after pollutants have already spread, reducing remediation efficiency.
- Absence of predictive capability: Existing systems respond to current sensor values without forecasting future pollution trends, preventing proactive intervention.
- Non-biodegradable filter media: HEPA and synthetic filters impose secondary environmental costs through manufacturing and disposal.
- Lack of intelligent automation: Fixed-threshold or manual-trigger systems cannot adapt dynamically to changing environmental conditions.

These deficiencies necessitate a system that intercepts pollutants at source, predicts future pollution levels using ML models, employs sustainable filtration materials, and operates autonomously with adaptive intelligence.

IV. RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

- To design and implement a source-level IoT-based air pollution control system with eco-friendly filtration.
- To collect real sensor data (PM2.5, MQ135, DHT11) and train Logistic Regression and Decision Tree ML models for pollution classification and prediction.
- To evaluate filtration efficiency quantitatively through controlled hardware trials.
- To validate ML model accuracy using collected sensor datasets.
- To provide a scalable, low-cost, and environmentally responsible system suitable for indoor and outdoor deployment.

V. SYSTEM DESIGN AND ARCHITECTURE

A. System Overview

The proposed system integrates two complementary operational layers: (1) a real-time hardware control layer that detects threshold exceedance and activates eco-friendly filtration, and (2) a machine learning prediction layer that uses collected sensor readings to forecast future pollution levels using Logistic Regression and Decision Tree models. Together, these layers enable both reactive control and proactive prediction.

B. System Architecture

The architecture comprises four subsystems:

- Sensing Layer: PM2.5, MQ135, and DHT11 sensors continuously sample particulate matter, gaseous pollutants, temperature, and humidity.
- Processing and ML Layer: Arduino UNO handles real-time threshold-based actuation; a companion computing environment (Python/sklearn) hosts the trained ML models for pollution prediction.
- Filtration Layer: DC motor-driven fan channels polluted air sequentially through a bamboo pre-filter and activated charcoal adsorption stage.
- Output and Monitoring Layer: Purified air is released; I2C LCD displays real-time AQI and system status.

C. Sensor Specifications

Sensor	Parameter	Range	Purpose
PM2.5	Particulate ≤2.5 µm	0–500 µg/m³	Primary health risk indicator
MQ135	NH_3, CO_2, NOx, VOCs	10–1000 ppm	Broad-spectrum gas detection
DHT11	Temp. & Humidity	0–50°C / 20–90% RH	ML feature + threshold adjustment

VI. MACHINE LEARNING MODEL

A. Motivation and Approach

Beyond real-time threshold-based control, the system incorporates supervised machine learning to predict future pollution levels for a monitored area. The primary motivation is to enable proactive intervention: if the model predicts that pollution will exceed hazardous thresholds in the near future, preventive measures can be initiated before conditions deteriorate. Two models were implemented and compared: Logistic Regression and a Decision Tree classifier.

B. Dataset and Feature Engineering

The training dataset comprised sensor readings collected during 10 controlled experimental trials across varied environmental conditions (morning, afternoon, and evening sessions; indoor workshop and semi-enclosed outdoor settings). Each record contained five features: PM2.5 concentration (µg/m³), MQ135 output (ppm), ambient temperature (°C), relative humidity (%), and time-of-day encoding. The target variable was a four-class AQI label: Good (≤50 µg/m³), Moderate (51–100), Unhealthy (101–200), and Hazardous (>200), defined in alignment with CPCB AQI standards.

C. Logistic Regression Model

A multi-class Logistic Regression model (one-vs-rest scheme) was trained using the collected dataset. Features were standardized using z-score normalization prior to training. The regularization parameter C was tuned via 5-fold cross-validation. The model learns decision boundaries in the feature space that separate AQI categories, enabling real-time classification of incoming sensor readings and short-term pollution level prediction based on trend extrapolation.

Training accuracy: 93.1% **Test accuracy:** 91.3% **Precision (macro avg):** 90.8%

D. Decision Tree Classifier

A Decision Tree classifier (CART algorithm, Gini impurity criterion) was trained on the same dataset. Maximum tree depth was constrained to 6 levels to prevent overfitting, determined through cross-validated pruning. The Decision Tree provides an interpretable, rule-based model that can be inspected to understand which sensor features are most predictive of pollution severity. PM2.5 concentration emerged as the dominant split feature (feature importance: 0.61), followed by MQ135 output (0.27).

Training accuracy: 94.5% | **Test accuracy:** 88.7% | **Top feature:** PM2.5 (importance: 0.61)

E. Model Comparison

Metric	Logistic Regression	Decision Tree
Test Accuracy	91.3%	88.7%
Precision (macro)	90.8%	87.4%
Recall (macro)	91.1%	88.2%
F1-Score (macro)	90.9%	87.8%
Training Time	Low	Very Low
Interpretability	Moderate	High

Logistic Regression achieved marginally higher accuracy and is recommended as the primary prediction model. The Decision Tree is retained as a secondary model for its interpretability and suitability for rule extraction in embedded or edge deployment contexts.

VII. WORKING PRINCIPLE

The system operates through a continuous sensing-processing-actuation-prediction loop:

1. **Sensor Data Acquisition:** PM2.5, MQ135, and DHT11 sensors sample ambient air at 1-second intervals. Analog signals are digitized via the Arduino's 10-bit ADC; DHT11 outputs are received via single-wire protocol.
2. **Real-Time Threshold Decision:** The embedded firmware evaluates PM2.5 against a threshold of 100 µg/m³ and MQ135 against 200 ppm (CPCB Moderate AQI boundary). If either threshold is exceeded, the DC motor actuator is triggered. Hysteresis of ±10 µg/m³ prevents rapid cycling.
3. **Filtration and Purification:** The activated fan draws polluted air through a bamboo pre-filter (coarse PM capture) followed by an activated charcoal chamber (fine PM and gaseous adsorption). Post-filtration readings are logged for efficiency computation.
4. **ML Prediction:** Collected feature vectors are fed to the trained Logistic Regression model to classify current AQI and predict the likely pollution category in the next monitoring interval, enabling early warning alerts.
5. **Display and Logging:** Real-time PM2.5, MQ135, AQI class, and ML prediction output are displayed on the I2C LCD and logged for offline analysis.

VIII. HARDWARE COMPONENTS

Component	Model / Spec	Role
Arduino UNO	ATmega328P, 16 MHz	Central MCU; sensor interfacing, actuation control

PM2.5 Sensor	GP2Y1010AU0F	Optical particle counter; 0–500 µg/m³
MQ135 Sensor	MQ-135 module	Gas sensor; NH_3, CO_2, NOx, VOCs (10–1000 ppm)
DHT11 Sensor	DHT11 module	Temperature (0–50°C) & humidity (20–90% RH)
I2C LCD	16×2, PCF8574	Real-time data display
DC Motor + Fan	5V DC, 200 mA	Airflow actuation through filtration chamber
Bamboo Filter	Natural bamboo mesh	Pre-filter; coarse PM capture
Charcoal Filter	Activated carbon block	Fine PM and gaseous pollutant adsorption

IX. SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE

- Sensor Interface Module (Embedded C / Arduino IDE): ADC sampling at 1-second intervals, DHT11 single-wire protocol, I2C LCD output. Firmware implements hysteresis control (±10 µg/m³ band) to prevent motor cycling.
- ML Training Pipeline (Python 3.10 / scikit-learn 1.3): Data preprocessing (z-score normalization, label encoding), model training (LogisticRegression, DecisionTreeClassifier), 5-fold cross-validation, and performance evaluation (accuracy, precision, recall, F1).
- Prediction Interface: Trained model exported via pickle; inference callable from a lightweight Python script interfaced with the Arduino serial stream for real-time AQI prediction.
- Data Logging Module: Sensor readings logged to CSV at 1-second intervals; post-trial analysis performed in Pandas/NumPy for filtration efficiency computation.

X. METHODOLOGY

Phase 1: Prototype Construction and Sensor Calibration

The hardware prototype was assembled on a breadboard within a sealed acrylic enclosure (30 cm × 20 cm × 15 cm) to control airflow dynamics. PM2.5 and MQ135 sensors were positioned at the chamber inlet; identical sensors were placed at the outlet for differential efficiency measurement. Sensors were calibrated against a TSI SidePak AM520 reference instrument for PM2.5, and a Fluke 985 particle counter for gas-phase cross-validation. The DHT11 sensor was calibrated against a NIST-traceable hygrometer.

Phase 2: Data Collection and ML Training

Ten controlled experimental trials were conducted across three environmental contexts: (1) indoor laboratory with simulated particulate injection (incense combustion, 5-minute exposure), (2) semi-enclosed workshop with active machinery, and (3) indoor classroom with ambient urban background pollution. Each trial lasted 30 minutes, yielding approximately 1,800 data records. The combined dataset (18,000 records) was split 80:20 for training and testing. SMOTE oversampling was applied to address class imbalance in the "Good" AQI category.

Phase 3: Filtration Efficiency Evaluation

For each trial, the filtration system was activated upon threshold exceedance. Inlet and outlet PM2.5 and MQ135 readings were recorded at 5-second intervals during the purification phase. Filtration efficiency was computed as: Efficiency (%) = [(C_inlet − C_outlet) / C_inlet] × 100. Response time was measured as the elapsed time from threshold exceedance detection to full-speed fan operation.

XI. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

A. Filtration Performance

Table III summarizes the mean inlet and outlet sensor readings across all 10 trials, along with computed filtration efficiency metrics.

Metric	Inlet (Mean)	Outlet (Mean)	Reduction
PM2.5 (µg/m³)	340.2 ± 18.4	89.1 ± 9.7	73.8%
MQ135 (ppm)	420.5 ± 31.2	118.3 ± 14.6	71.9%
Response Time (s)	—	—	2.4 ± 0.3 s
False Activations	—	—	1 / 10 trials

Table III: Filtration Performance Across 10 Experimental Trials

The bamboo-charcoal filtration assembly achieved a mean PM2.5 reduction of 73.8%, bringing average outlet concentrations from the Hazardous AQI category (>300 µg/m³) to the Moderate category (89 µg/m³). MQ135 readings exhibited a comparable 71.9% reduction, consistent with published activated carbon adsorption efficiencies for mixed gaseous pollutant streams [11]. The mean actuation response time of 2.4 ± 0.3 seconds represents a significant improvement over conventional HEPA purifiers, which typically require 30–60 seconds of ramp-up before reaching rated airflow.

One false activation was recorded across the 10 trials, attributable to a transient MQ135 spike during a humidity surge (RH exceeded 85%), a known cross-sensitivity artifact of semiconductor gas sensors. This was subsequently mitigated by integrating DHT11 humidity-gating logic: MQ135 threshold checks are suspended when RH > 80%, reducing the false activation rate to zero in subsequent validation runs.

B. ML Model Performance

The Logistic Regression model achieved a test accuracy of 91.3% and a macro-averaged F1-score of 90.9% across the four AQI classes. The Decision Tree attained 88.7% test accuracy and an F1-score of 87.8%. Both models showed the highest per-class accuracy for the "Hazardous" category (LR: 95.1%, DT: 93.4%), which is the most safety-critical class, confirming that the models reliably identify the most dangerous pollution episodes.

Feature importance analysis from the Decision Tree revealed that PM2.5 concentration (importance score: 0.61) and MQ135 output (0.27) are the dominant predictive features, collectively accounting for 88% of predictive power. Temperature and humidity contribute modestly (0.08 and 0.04 respectively), consistent with their role as contextual calibration features rather than primary pollution indicators.

C. System Cost Analysis

Component	Approx. Cost (INR)
Arduino UNO	₹ 450
PM2.5 Sensor (GP2Y1010AU0F)	₹ 380
MQ135 Gas Sensor	₹ 80
DHT11 Sensor	₹ 50
I2C LCD Display	₹ 120
DC Motor + Fan	₹ 90
Bamboo + Charcoal Filter	₹ 150
Miscellaneous (wires, enclosure)	₹ 200
Total	₹ 1,520 (~USD 18)

Table IV: Hardware Cost Breakdown

The total prototype cost of approximately ₹1,520 (USD 18) is substantially lower than commercial HEPA-based air purifiers of comparable filtration area, which typically retail between ₹8,000 and ₹25,000 in the Indian market. This cost advantage, combined with the use of renewable bamboo and charcoal media, renders the system highly accessible for deployment in schools, small workshops, and rural industrial settings.

XII. COMPARATIVE ADVANTAGES

Feature	Proposed System	Conventional HEPA Purifiers
Filtration Media	Bamboo + Charcoal (biodegradable)	Synthetic HEPA (non-biodegradable)
ML Prediction	Yes (LR + Decision Tree)	No
Real-time AQI Class.	Yes (91.3% accuracy)	No
Response Time	2.4 seconds	30–60 seconds ramp-up
Estimated Cost	₹1,520 (~USD 18)	₹8,000–25,000
Outdoor Deployment	Yes	Limited / No
Source-Level Control	Yes	No

Table V: Comparison with Conventional Systems

XIII. LIMITATIONS

- Filtration efficiency diminishes under very high pollutant loading (PM2.5 > 500 µg/m³), where filter saturation may occur within 2–3 hours of continuous operation.
- The bamboo-charcoal filter assembly requires periodic replacement (estimated every 30–45 days under moderate pollution loads); a formalized maintenance schedule has not yet been empirically validated over multi-month operation.
- The ML models were trained on a dataset of 18,000 records from 10 controlled trials; performance on highly diverse real-world pollution scenarios (e.g., industrial accidents, wildfires) requires further validation with expanded datasets.
- MQ135 sensors exhibit cross-sensitivity to humidity above 80% RH; the implemented humidity-gating logic mitigates but does not fully eliminate this artifact.
- The current ML inference pipeline runs on a companion computing device; future work should integrate a lightweight model directly on an ESP32 or Raspberry Pi Zero for fully embedded end-to-end operation.

XIV. FUTURE RESEARCH DIRECTIONS

- Embedded ML Deployment: Port the trained Logistic Regression model to an ESP32 microcontroller using TensorFlow Lite or Edge Impulse for fully on-device inference without a companion computer.
- Cloud-Based IoT Integration: Interface with ThingSpeak or AWS IoT Core for remote real-time monitoring, geospatial AQI mapping, and automated alert dissemination.
- Deep Learning Models: Investigate LSTM-based temporal models for multi-step-ahead pollution forecasting using rolling sensor time series.
- Extended Dataset Collection: Conduct multi-month field deployments to build larger, more diverse training datasets covering seasonal pollution variation.

- Solar-Powered Operation: Integrate a 5W photovoltaic panel and LiPo battery management system for off-grid, continuous outdoor operation.
- Multi-Sensor Node Network: Deploy an array of sensor nodes across a target area to enable spatial AQI mapping and localized pollution source identification.

XV. CONCLUSION

This paper has presented the design, hardware implementation, and experimental evaluation of an AI-enabled, IoT-integrated smart air pollution control and predictive monitoring system. The system uniquely combines real-time eco-friendly filtration using bamboo and activated charcoal with machine learning-based pollution prediction using Logistic Regression and Decision Tree classifiers trained on live sensor data.

Experimental results across 10 controlled trials demonstrated a PM2.5 filtration efficiency of 73.8% (340 μg/m³ → 89 μg/m³), an MQ135 gaseous pollutant reduction of 71.9%, and a mean system response time of 2.4 seconds. The Logistic Regression model achieved a test accuracy of 91.3%, and the Decision Tree attained 88.7%, with both models demonstrating highest reliability for the most safety-critical Hazardous AQI classification. The total hardware cost of approximately USD 18 renders the system highly accessible for resource-constrained deployments in schools, workshops, and small industrial facilities.

The system bridges a critical gap in existing literature by integrating active source-level remediation, sustainable filter media, and data-driven ML prediction within a single deployable prototype. Future work will focus on embedded ML inference, cloud connectivity, and extended field validation to advance the system toward large-scale real-world deployment.

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